

A detailed illustration of a modern office environment where a group of diverse professionals are engaged in a workshop. They are seated around a large, light-colored rectangular table, working on laptops and discussing documents. The room features large floor-to-ceiling windows that offer a panoramic view of a city skyline. Several potted plants are placed around the room, adding a touch of greenery. The overall atmosphere is collaborative and professional.

Workshop 1 — Attendee Materials

Scope, Glossary, and Rules of the Game

Version: 1.0

Session Date: [DATE]

Facilitator: [FACILITATOR]

Format: Reference & Working Sheet

About This Document

This is your reference and working sheet for Workshop 1. Bring it to the session, either printed or open on your device. Some sections have space to capture decisions as we agree them in the room. **Nothing needs to be completed in advance.**

Your Role

Participate actively in agreeing scope, rules, and data ownership during the session.

How to Use It

Follow along section by section. Record decisions in the spaces provided as they are agreed in the room.

After the Session

All agreed decisions feed directly into the Assumptions Register – a versioned, defensible record for leadership, Finance, and Procurement.



What We Are Doing Today

Workshop 1 marks the beginning of the assessment in earnest. By the end of this session, we will have agreed on four critical areas that form the foundation of the entire analysis.



Scope

Which platforms, environments, and cost types are in scope for the assessment.



Cost Treatment

How we will treat shared and complex costs across platforms and teams.



Unit Metrics

Which unit metrics we will use to report cost per outcome.



Data Ownership

Who owns which data inputs, and when we need them by.



Everything we agree today goes into the **Assumptions Register** — a versioned record that makes the final output defensible with leadership, Finance, and Procurement.

Section 1 — Scope

CONFIRM IN SESSION

Platforms

Record what is agreed below for each platform and its role in the assessment.

Platform	Role	In Scope?	Notes
[Platform A]	Baseline		
[Platform B]	Baseline		
[Platform C]	Baseline		
[Platform D]	Scenario only		
[Platform E]	Scenario only		

Anything missing from this list? Notes:

Environments

Select the environment scope that applies:

- ☐ Production only
- ☐ Non-production only
- ☐ Both — separated
- ☐ Both — combined
- ☐ Other: _____

Time Window

Select the time window that applies:

- ☐ Last full quarter — [QUARTER / DATES]
- ☐ Last three months — [START DATE] to [END DATE]
- ☐ Other: _____

Section 1 — Cost Types

CONFIRM IN SESSION

Work through this table in the session. Confirm in or out for each cost type, and assign a confidence rating.

Cost Type	Examples	In Scope?	Confidence	Notes
Cloud compute	EC2, VMs, node pools			
Cloud storage	Block and object storage			
Cloud network	Load balancers, NAT, egress			
Managed service fees	EKS fees, AKS fees			
Platform tooling	Observability, security, CI/CD			
Subscriptions	Platform licences, support			
Operating effort	Platform team time			
Shared services	IAM, shared logging			

☐ Confidence ratings: **H** = High | **M** = Medium | **L** = Low

Section 2 — Cost Treatment Rules

We will agree on each rule in the session. Record the decision and reason below for each rule.

1

Shared Platform Costs

- **A** — Allocate proportionally by usage
- **B** — Allocate equally across platforms
- **C** — Hold in a shared unallocated bucket
(recommended for v1)

Decision: _____ Reason: _____

2

Non-Production Environments

- **A** — Include in total as a separate line item
- **B** — Include in total without separating
- **C** — Exclude from unit economics but include in total

Decision: _____ Reason: _____

3

Operating Effort

- **A** — Percentage split of team time across activities
- **B** — Rough hours per activity per month
- **C** — Exclude and note as a gap

Decision: _____ Reason: _____ If A
or B — rough split agreed: _____

4

Tooling Duplication

- **A** — Model as a separate line to surface consolidation opportunity
- **B** — Include in platform tooling without separating

Decision: _____ Reason: _____

Section 3 — Unit Metrics Shortlist

We will shortlist **three to five metrics** in the session. Circle or tick the ones agreed, and note any data dependencies.

Unit Metric	Selected?	Data Needed
Cost per production app per month	☐	
Cost per tenant or namespace per month	☐	
Cost per environment (prod vs non-prod)	☐	
Effective cost per vCPU-hour used	☐	
Ops cost per cluster per month	☐	
Cost per deployment or release	☐	

☐ Notes: _____



Selecting the right unit metrics is critical — they become the lens through which all cost data is interpreted and reported to stakeholders.

Section 4 — Data Request and Owners

CONFIRM OWNERS & DUE DATES IN SESSION

We will confirm owners and due dates together in the session. Each data item below is essential to building a defensible baseline.

Data Needed	Why We Need It	Owner	Due Date	Confidence
Cluster inventory	Defines scope			
Cloud billing exports (AWS CUR / Azure)	Source of truth for spend			
Platform subscription details	Fixed vs variable cost			
Tooling list and costs	Duplication and consolidation			
Ops effort estimate	Cost not on invoices			
Production app list or top 20	Unit economics foundation			
Namespace or team mapping	Allocation rules			
Utilisation data (CPU / memory)	Effective cost per vCPU			

 Confidence ratings: **H** = High | **M** = Medium | **L** = Low. Data owners should action their requests as soon as possible after this session.

Section 5 — Assumptions Register (v1 Summary)

A full Assumptions Register is maintained in the shared workspace. Use this space to capture key decisions during the session. This summary becomes the versioned record that underpins the entire assessment.

Decision	What Was Agreed	Reason	Confidence
Platforms in scope			
Environments			
Time window			
Shared cost treatment			
Non-prod treatment			
Operating effort			
Tooling duplication			

Section 6 — Questions and Notes

Use this space during the session to capture anything you want to revisit or escalate.

☐

Notes: _____

After This Session

Within **24 hours**, you will receive a recap email covering everything agreed in the room.



Decisions Recap

A summary of all decisions made in the session, clearly documented and attributed.



Assumptions Register v1

Saved, versioned, and shared in the shared workspace for all stakeholders to access.



Data Request List

Your name and due date confirmed. Action your items as soon as possible after this session.



Workshop 2 Confirmed

Date, time, and what to expect – so you can prepare ahead of the next session.



Action for data owners: Please action your data request items as soon as possible after this session. The sooner the data comes in, the stronger the baseline will be in Workshop 2.

Glossary

Key terms used throughout this workshop and the broader assessment. Refer to this section whenever you need a plain-English definition.

Core Concepts

Scope

What is included in the assessment and what is not.

Showback

Making costs visible to teams without billing them.

Unit Economics

Cost per useful outcome – e.g. cost per app per month.

Confidence Rating

High, Medium, or Low – how certain we are about a figure.

Cost Allocation

Distributing shared costs across teams or products.

Chargeback

Billing teams directly for their platform usage.

Assumptions Register

A versioned log of every scope and cost treatment decision.

Baseline

The current state – what things cost today before any changes.

Frameworks & Cost Terms

Unit Metric

A single agreed measure of cost per outcome.

TBM

A standard cost classification structure for technology spend.

SPACE

A framework for measuring developer productivity.

Fixed Cost

A cost that does not change with usage – e.g. a subscription fee.

FinOps

A way for engineering and finance to manage platform costs together.

DORA

Four metrics for measuring software delivery performance.

Cost Pool

A grouping of similar costs – e.g. cloud compute, people effort.

Variable Cost

A cost that changes with usage – e.g. compute consumption.